

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

What is Degrowth?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 25

No.	Sentence
1	Phil admits he tends to _____ rather than drive.
2	Phil also tries to _____ things at home.
3	Hannah points out that dealing with climate change cannot rely on _____ alone.
4	To address the crisis, Hannah argues we need to change the way our _____ works.
5	In the past, governments have always aimed to _____ the economy.
6	Degrowth supporters believe economies should stop _____.
7	The focus should shift to using fewer of the Earth's _____.
8	Those who back this idea are commonly referred to as _____.
9	They target production that is considered not _____.
10	_____ (cheap, rapidly produced clothing).
11	the _____ industry.
12	Many economists argue degrowth would lead to more _____.
13	Professor Fankhauser claims degrowth fails to appreciate the power of _____.
14	He also says it overlooks the need for investment in _____.
15	He further questions the social _____ of what degrowthers propose.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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What is Phil's attitude towards his own environmental habits?

- A He is proud of his consistent efforts to protect the environment
- B He admits his actions are insufficient despite making some effort
- C He is indifferent to environmental issues and avoids the topic
- D He is frustrated that others do not share his green lifestyle

What does Hannah imply when she says "it's not up to you and me"?

- A Individuals should be held legally responsible for climate damage
- B Governments alone should be blamed for the climate crisis
- C Personal habits are completely irrelevant to environmental outcomes
- D Addressing climate change requires structural economic transformation

According to Hannah, what has traditionally been the priority of governments regarding the economy?

- A Expanding output, employment, and material wealth continuously
- B Reducing dependence on fossil fuels and non-renewable resources
- C Balancing economic development with environmental conservation
- D Encouraging citizens to consume fewer goods and live sustainably

What does Alvaro Alvarez clarify about the degrowth position?

- A It calls for the complete elimination of all industrial production
- B It focuses exclusively on reducing carbon emissions from transport
- C It targets the reduction of specific harmful sectors, not all production
- D It proposes replacing economic growth with government-controlled output

Which of the following best describes what "fast fashion" refers to, as explained in the transcript?

- A Clothing brands that use recycled materials to lower production costs
- B Garments produced at low cost and high speed to encourage frequent purchasing
- C A retail strategy that limits clothing supply to increase consumer demand
- D Fashion trends that spread rapidly through social media and online platforms

What concern do some economists raise about degrowth, according to Hannah?

- A It would cause governments to lose control over monetary policy
- B It would slow down international trade and damage export industries
- C It would reduce consumer spending and destabilise financial markets
- D It could worsen poverty and make resolving the climate crisis more difficult

What is Professor Fankhauser's central criticism of degrowth?

- A It fails to recognise the role of technological progress and new investment
- B It relies too heavily on government regulation to control industrial output
- C It ignores the economic benefits that come from international cooperation
- D It overestimates how quickly societies can transition to renewable energy

In Professor Fankhauser's view, what does degrowth fail to adequately consider regarding society?

- A The public's willingness to pay higher taxes for environmental programmes
- B The speed at which developing nations can adopt sustainable technologies
- C The realistic likelihood that the proposed social changes can be carried out
- D The cultural differences that affect how communities respond to policy shifts

What does Phil suggest when he uses the word "feasible" in a sentence about the podcast?

- A He is uncertain whether the discussion will cover all the planned topics
- B He is concerned that the episode may run significantly over its time limit
- C He is questioning whether degrowth is a realistic solution to climate change
- D He is illustrating the meaning of the word through a relatable everyday example

What conclusion can be inferred about the debate over degrowth based on the overall discussion?

- A Most economists have recently shifted their support towards degrowth policies
- B The concept remains contested, with supporters and critics holding opposing views
- C Degrowth has been widely adopted by governments as a response to climate change
- D The disagreement centres mainly on which industries should be reduced in size